

VIJO JOHN

Gen AI & Agentic AI Strategy Leader | Finance, BFSI, Fund Administration

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Target: Agentic AI, Gen AI Product Strategy, AI Transformation, and BFSI AI leadership roles

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Gen AI and Agentic AI strategy leader with CFO-domain depth. 19+ years across BFSI, including early-career roles at Convergys and MetLife, spanning fund accounting, financial reporting, FP&A, governance, controls, taxation, operations, and post-M&A integration. Builds practical AI systems for the modern CFO office and fund administration, translating regulated finance workflows into agentic products, evaluation harnesses, and adoption-ready operating models.

Hands-on builder across LangGraph, RAG, LLM evaluation, Qdrant, FastAPI, Streamlit, Azure OpenAI, Groq, and Llama. Designs finance AI products from problem framing and PRDs through prototype, evaluation, governance, and stakeholder adoption. Comfortable operating across CFO, audit, engineering, product, and operations teams, with the credibility of a VP, Head of Finance and the technical fluency to prototype what engineering ships.

Differentiator: combines board-facing finance leadership with production-oriented Gen AI execution. Focus areas include FP&A narrative reporting, CFO decision dashboards, NAV break investigation, SOI review, finance close automation, AP / O2C / R2R workflows, auditability, responsible AI governance, and human-in-the-loop controls. IIM Kozhikode MBA, Six Sigma Black Belt, former CISO, ISO 27001 / 9001 implementation experience, and six consecutive years of ITGC / SOC1 audits with zero material findings.

AI LEADERSHIP VALUE PROPOSITION

AI Strategy	Owns AI opportunity portfolios, build-vs-buy decisions, value-at-stake sizing, CFO / board-ready business cases, responsible AI controls, adoption roadmaps, and stakeholder alignment.
Hands-On Delivery	Builds agentic workflows, RAG systems, LLM evaluation harnesses, prompt routing, logging, telemetry, and prototype-to-deployable applications using modern AI engineering patterns.
BFSI Domain Edge	Deep finance context across fund administration, financial reporting, FP&A, governance, statutory compliance, tax controls, NAV, AP / O2C / R2R, and regulated operating environments.

CORE AI & FINANCE COMPETENCIES

Agentic AI	LangGraph orchestration supervisor / worker routing reflection loops tool-using agents stateful workflows human-in-the-loop controls AI governance.
RAG & LLMOps	Qdrant embeddings semantic retrieval PDF / document RAG Azure OpenAI Groq Llama LLM-as-judge groundedness checks eval logging.
Finance AI	FP&A narratives CFO dashboards NAV exception management SOI review close automation reconciliation workflows audit trail design model-risk controls.
Product Strategy	Problem framing PRDs user stories acceptance criteria OKRs prioritization ROI cases release planning CFO / CTO / audit stakeholder management.

SELECTED AI & TRANSFORMATION IMPACT

- **Built AI Finance OS:** Autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation, and CFO decision dashboards.
- **Built FP&A Narrative Reporting Copilot:** Private copilot converting performance data, variance drivers, and management-reporting context into CFO-ready commentary for MIS packs and board discussions.
- **Delivered BFSI AI prototypes:** NAV break investigation, SOI review, enterprise ethics advisor, timesheet intelligence, and agentic RAG writing workflows with evaluation and governance patterns.
- **Improved finance operations:** Delivered ~USD 200,000 annualized savings, 40% productivity improvement, 80% faster reporting prep, BD10 to BD8 book close, and MIS acceleration by 2 days.
- **Governance record:** Six consecutive years of ITGC / SOC1 audits with zero material findings; CISO experience, ISO 27001 certification, SOC readiness, and control-framework design.

AI PRODUCTS, CONCEIVED, DESIGNED & DELIVERED

AI Finance OS

FLAGSHIP | Python | FastAPI | LangGraph | PostgreSQL | Streamlit

Autonomous finance operating layer with LangGraph-orchestrated agents for bookkeeping, MIS, invoicing, intercompany, reconciliation workflows, and CFO decision dashboards.

FP&A Narrative Reporting Copilot

LATEST | Private repo | FP&A | narrative reporting | variance commentary

Private copilot converting financial performance data, variance drivers, and management-reporting context into executive-ready commentary for CFO reviews, MIS packs, board updates, and performance discussions.

NAV Break Investigation Agent

LangGraph | Azure OpenAI | Qdrant RAG

Detection to Investigation to Reflection agent loop grounded by RAG over NAV validation rules and investigation playbooks, with logging and an offline evaluation harness.

SOI Review Agent

8-agent pipeline | PDF extraction | ASC 946 RAG

Agent pipeline automating Schedule of Investments review under US GAAP ASC 946, including PDF extraction, SOI detection, validation, prior-cycle comparison, and preventive controls.

Enterprise Ethics Advisor

Multimodal RAG | CLIP | fully local

Fully local multimodal RAG for corporate ethics guidance with policy-diagram and text retrieval for governed AI advisory without external data exposure.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

McLaren Strategic Solutions, Vice President, Head of Finance | Jun 2025 - Present

- Lead the CFO-track finance agenda across accounting, controllership, financial reporting, taxation, FP&A, treasury, governance, controls, and board reporting across India and the US.
- Run finance end-to-end as design partner for AI products: AP, O2C, R2R, book closure, export invoicing, budgetary controls, earnout calculations, statutory compliance, and presales support.
- Design CFO-level dashboards, MIS packs, variance commentary, and performance reporting while translating finance priorities into agentic AI workflows for invoicing, reconciliation, reporting, and controls.
- Partner with senior leadership on AI strategy, governance, roadmap, profitability, risk, and audit readiness; bridge business stakeholders, engineering, finance operations, and auditors.

State Street, Bangalore, Sr. AVP / AVP / Sr. Manager, Financial Reporting | Jul 2018 - Jun 2025

- Progressive growth: Sr. Manager (2018), AVP (2020), Senior AVP (2023), Financial Reporting and Arc Reporting Product Owner.
- Owned requirements backlog and stakeholder priorities for the Arc financial-reporting platform, partnering with technology to drive reporting automation, data integrity, and on-time regulatory delivery.
- Built and led multi-tier reporting teams delivering US GAAP-compliant financial statements and reconciliations on schedule, improving client satisfaction and retention.
- Oversaw ITGC and SOC1 audits with zero material findings; accountable for reporting systems, data-feed integrity, internal controls, and governance relevance.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE, CONTINUED

HSBC EDPI, Gurgaon, Manager, Business Finance | Dec 2016 - Jul 2018

- Finance business partner for global operations, strategic insights, annual operating plans, budgeting, forecasting, and variance analysis to guide business and operational decisions.
- Owned intercompany charging, recovery, and reconciliation; designed cost-recovery strategies and intercompany reporting across business units, ensuring accurate allocation and audit-ready reconciliations.
- Delivered executive reporting solutions, flash reports, standardized reporting packs, and CFO-level financial models for senior-leadership presentations.
- Engineered advanced data consolidation and reporting tools using Excel and Power Query, improving accuracy, consistency, and reporting timelines.

Ameriprise, Gurgaon, Trainer to Group Leader, Financial Reporting & Tax | Oct 2010 - Dec 2016

- Grew from Fund Accounting trainer to Group Leader across financial reporting and tax, building deep accounting, reconciliation, reporting, and people-leadership foundations.
- Led teams responsible for production delivery, quality control, knowledge transfer, KPI tracking, training, and operational governance.

Early Career, Convergys and MetLife | 2006 - 2010

- Built early-career grounding in operations, service delivery, training, quality discipline, team coordination, and process execution across global financial-services environments.

FINANCE DOMAIN DEPTH

Reporting & Controls	US GAAP, Ind AS, statutory accounts, audit readiness, ITGC / SOC1, internal controls, governance frameworks, data security protocols, ISO 27001, CISO experience.
FP&A & Board Insight	Budgeting, forecasting, variance analysis, CFO packs, flash reports, financial models, board-facing dashboards, margin analysis, performance reporting, and business recommendations.
Tax & Compliance	GST, TDS, India payroll, FEMA, MCA / ROC compliance, direct and indirect tax compliance, statutory filings, auditor and legal-advisor coordination.
Operations	Fund accounting, NAV, AP / P2P, O2C, AR, collections, DSO, R2R, month / quarter / annual close, intercompany accounting, reconciliation, billing, export invoicing, budgetary controls, and treasury / cash management.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

MBA	Executive Post Graduate Programme, Strategy & Finance, Indian Institute of Management (IIM), Kozhikode, 2023.
Certifications	Six Sigma Black Belt ISO 27001 Implementer ISO 9001 Implementer Leader as a Coach.
Domains	Capital Markets and Fund Administration Banking Insurance IT US GAAP Indian Accounting Standards (Ind AS).